

Pterodactylus

TEH-roe-DACK-till-us

- **When** 150–144 million years ago (Jurassic)
- **Fossil location** Germany
- **Habitat** Coastal
- **Size** 12 in (30 cm) long

Many complete skeleton finds have ensured that *Pterodactylus* has become one of the best known of pterosaurs. This animal had a very short tail and a longer neck than earlier pterosaurs, making it a better flyer.



▲ **PTERODACTYLUS** *This fossil discovered in Germany is one of the most complete and best-preserved pterosaur fossils known.*



Pterodactylus

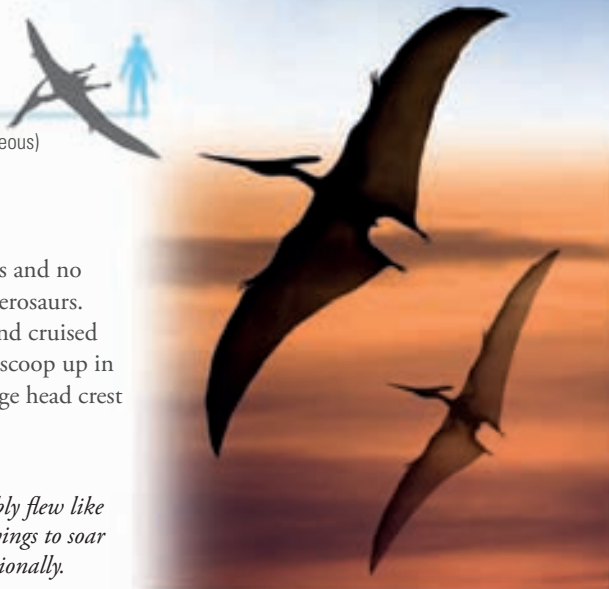
Pteranodon

teh-RAN-oh-don

- **When** 88–80 million years ago (Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** North America
- **Habitat** Coastal
- **Size** 23–30 ft (7–9 m) wingspan

This creature's name means "wings and no teeth." It was one of the largest pterosaurs. *Pteranodons* lived in huge flocks and cruised over the ocean looking for fish to scoop up in their slender, pointed beaks. A large head crest may have been used for display.

► **PTERANODON** *probably flew like an albatross, using its huge wings to soar and flapping them only occasionally.*



Dimorphodon

die-MORE-foe-don

- **When** 200–180 million years ago (Jurassic)
- **Fossil location** British Isles
- **Habitat** Coastal woodlands
- **Size** 24 in (60 cm) long

Dimorphodon's head was almost a third of its body length and contained two types of teeth, which was unusual for a pterosaur. (Its name actually means "two-form tooth.")

It probably hunted small vertebrates, such as lizardlike reptiles, snapping its jaws closed with immense speed to trap them.



Rhamphorhynchus

ram-foe-RINK-us

- **When** 150 million years ago (Jurassic)
- **Fossil location** Europe, Africa
- **Habitat** Coastal and riverside
- **Size** 16 in (40 cm) long

With its slim, spiked teeth, throat pouch, and long, narrow jaw, *Rhamphorhynchus* was perfectly adapted for the coastal environment in which it lived. Its long tail had a diamond-shaped flap of skin at the end and was perhaps used to help this pterosaur steer.

▼ **WINGS** *A pterosaur's wing was made of skin stretched between an extremely long finger bone and the leg.*

